the influence of persons linked to the wood-cutting/oil companies interested in obtaining facilities that would guarantee their economic activity in inviolate areas (Chavez 2003).

On 2 March 2008, the woodcutter Mariano Castellanos was speared to death by the isolated peoples that inhabited the Armadillo region. On 10 August 2009 in the 'Los Reyes' settlement formed by colonists an event occurred that involved the death of a female colonist and her children. These deaths were attributed to the isolated indigenes belonging to the Armadillo clan. The motives for the deaths were presumably the racket produced by the South Hormiguero Platform electricity plant of PetroOriental, operating in Block 14.

On 5 March 2013 the Taromenane people again reacted to the invasion of its territories. According to what the Wuaorani relate, the attackers had warned about their distress due to excessive noise, unrecognised cultivations, many foreigners, tree-cutting and the construction of the petroleum platform and had asked their Wuaorani brothers to deal with this. Not being able to do anything, the Taromenane attacked a pair of Wuaorani elders, killing them with lances. In revenge, the Wuaorani in turn attacked Taromenane settlements, killing at least twenty of them and kidnapping two small girls.

The highways that have invaded the forests, as well as deforestation and the ever-greater pressure on the isolated people's territories, are also problems. Road construction presupposes the concentrated presence of squadrons of workers and is also an incentive for trading in wood and forest species. At present there are Wuaorani families that have come to live next to the motorway built by Maxus, now in the hands of Repsol. This has caused even more conflict among the Wuaorani and the clans that are in voluntary isolation.

The struggle in the Yasuní zone is not a cultural one. It is a conflict generated by the oil and timber companies' presence. It is a problem for which the state is directly responsible because it does not stop the threat to the territories of people who have lived there for millions of years.

Conclusion

The varied Chinese geopolitical oil strategies have achieved access to petroleum sources in the short term. The firms have adjusted rapidly to the Andean region's political changes. Nevertheless, little has been done to respect national and international human rights norms. In Ecuador, the Chinese firms have notably contributed to the expansion of the extractive frontier, principally in the Yasuní, showing little or no interest in the consequences for the well-established peoples and the environment. They show scarce interest in bettering work conditions and